AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EA300A
Children's Literature (I)
MAIN
FINAL EXAM

2024-2025 / Spring Semester

Date: 3 June 2025
9:30 – 12:30

Number of Exam Pages: 7 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **3 hours**

INSTRUCTION

There are THREE sections in this exam paper:

1. You are required to answer TWO questions from Section 1. ONE question from Secti
   2. Section 3 is MANDATORY.
2. Answers in Section 1 should be in the form of short answers.
3. Answers in section 2 & 3 should be in standard essay format: Start with a thesis, end wit
   conclusion, define all important terms, and provide specific and appropriate examples. Anal
   and discuss the examples.
4. Edit your answers, paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
5. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
6. It is also necessary to refer to relevant critical essays to support your analysis.

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SECTION 1: SHORT ANSWERS (10 marks)

Answer TWO questions out of the following three questions in 50 words each.

1- "In 'Little Red Riding Hood and the Wolf', Dahl uses humor, irony, and an unexpected twist to critique traditional fairy tale conventions and engage his audience". Comment

(5 marks)

2- " The traditional version of *Little Red Riding Hood* upholds traditional gender roles by portraying the protagonist as a passive figure who requires a male rescuer". Comment.

(5 marks)

3- "In P. Pullman's *Northern Lights*, Lyra's character development reflects themes of mora responibility". Comment

(5 marks)

SECTION 2: POETRY ANALYSIS

Answer EITHER Question 1 OR Question 2 250 WORDS (20 MARKS)

Question 1: Analyse the following poem by Michael Rosen, in terms of form and content, focusing on the humorous tension between a child's chaotic behavior and a parent's attempt at control through routine.



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IF YOU DON'T PUT YOUR SHOES ON BEFORE I COUNT FIFTEEN

If you don't put your shoes on before I count fifteen then we won't go to the woods to climb the chestnut tree.
One.

BUT I CAN'T FIND THEM.

Two.

I CAN'T.

They're under the sofa. Three.

NO.....O YES.

Four Five Six

STOP THEY'VE GOT KNOTS THEY'VE GOT KNOTS.

You should untie the laces when you take your shoes off. Seven.

WILL YOU DO ONE SHOE WHILE I DO THE OTHER THEN?

Eight. But that would be cheating....

PLEASE

All right.

IT ALWAYS.....

Nine.

IT ALWAYS STICKS -I'LL USE MY TEETH.
Ten.

IT WON'T IT WON'T.....IT HAS - LOOK.

Eleven.

I'M NOT WEARING ANY SOCKS.

Twelve.

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STOP COUNTING STOP COUNTING. (MUM WHERE ARE MY SOCKS MUM?)

They're in your shoes. Where you left them.

I DIDN'T

Thirteen.

O THEY'RE INSIDE OUT AND UPSIDE DOWN AND BUNDLED UP.

Fourteen.

HAVE YOU DONE THE KNOT ON THE SHOE YOU WERE....

Yes. Put it on the right foot.

BUT SOCKS DON'T HAVE RIGHT AND WRONG FEET.

The shoes, silly.... Fourteen and a half.

I AM I AM. WAIT. DON'T GO TO THE WOODS WITHOUT ME. LOOK THATS O
SHOE ALREADY.

Fourteen and threequarters.

THERE

You haven't tied the bows yet.

WE COULD DO THAT ON THE WAY THERE?

No we won't. Fourteen and seven eighths.

HELP ME THEN- YOU KNOW I'M NOT FAST AT BOWS.

Fourteen and fifteen sixteeeeeeenths.

A SINGLE BOW IS ALL RIGHT, ISN'T IT.

Fifteen. We're off.

SEE I DID IT.
DIDN'T I?

Michael Rosen

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OR

Question 2: Analyse the following poem by Wendy Cope, in terms of form and content, focusing on its didactic (instructive) element.

Kenneth, who was too fond of bubble-gum and met an untimely end.

The chief defect of Kenneth Plumb
Was chewing too much bubble-gum.
He chewed away with all his might,
Morning, evening, noon and night.
Even (oh, it makes you weep)
Blowing bubbles in his sleep.
He simply couldn't get enough!
His face was covered with the stuff.
As for his teeth — oh, what a sight!
It was a wonder he could bite.
His loving mother and his dad
Both remonstrated with the lad.
Ken repaid them for the trouble
By blowing yet another bubble.
Twas no joke. It isn't funny
Spending all your pocket money
On the day's supply of gum –
Sometimes Kenny felt quite glum.
As he grew, so did his need –
There seemed no limit to his greed:
At ten he often put away
Ninety-seven packs a day.
Then at last he went too far
Sitting in his father's car,
Stuffing gum without a pause,

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Found that he had jammed his jaws.
He nudged his dad and pointed to
The mouthful that he couldn't chew.
'Well, spit it out if you can't chew it!'
Ken shook his head. He couldn't do it.
Before long he began to groan –
The gum was solid as a stone.
Dad took him to a builder's yard;
They couldn't help. It was too hard.
They called a doctor and he said,
'This silly boy will soon be dead.
His mouth's so full of bubble-gum
No nourishment can reach his tum.'
Remember Ken and please do not
Go buying too much you-know-what.

Wendy Cope

SECTION 3: CLOSE READING **(Mandatory) 250 WORDS (20 marks)**

Analyse the passage from P. Pullman's *Northern Lights* focusing on Lyra and Pan's psychological tension while interacting with Mrs. Coulter and her daemon. How does Pullman use contrasting tones and daemon symbolism in this passage to convey themes of manipulation and survival?

Lyra moaned and trembled uncontrollably, just as if she had been pulled out of water so cold tha her heart had nearly frozen. Pantalaimon simply lay against her bare skin, inside her clothes, loving her back to herself, but aware all the time of Mrs. Coulter, busy preparing a drink of something, and most of all of the golden monkey, whose hard little fingers had run swiftly over Lyra's body when only Pantalaimon could have noticed; and who had felt, around her waist, the oilskin pouch with its contents.

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"Sit up, dear, and drink this," said Mrs. Coulter, and her gentle arm slipped around Lyra's b and lifted her. Lyra clenched herself, but relaxed almost at once as Pantalaimon thought to We're only safe as long as we pretend. She opened her eyes and found that they'd been containing tears, and to her surprise and shame she sobbed and sobbed.

Mrs. Coulter made sympathetic sounds and put the drink into the monkey's hands while sh mopped Lyra's eyes with a scented handkerchief.

"Cry as much as you need to, darling," said that soft voice, and Lyra determined to stop as as she possibly could. She struggled to hold back the tears, she pressed her lips together, sh choked down the sobs that still shook her chest.

Pantalaimon played the same game: fool them, fool them. He became a mouse and crept av from Lyra's hand to sniff timidly at the drink in the monkey's clutch. It was innocuous: an infusion of chamomile, nothing more. He crept back to Lyra's shoulder and whispered, "Dr it."...

"Lyra, darling," Mrs. Coulter murmured, stroking her hair.

"I thought we'd lost you forever! What happened? Did you get lost? Did someone take you out of the flat?"

"Yeah," Lyra whispered.

"Who was it, dear?"

"A man and a woman."

"Guests at the party?"

"I think so..."

Northern Lights **(1995) Chapter 17 'The Witches'.**

End of Exam

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